First Screening Interview Cheat Sheet
(Based on Recent Interviews)

Question: 1 Tell Me about Yourself

or
Can you walk me through your background?
or
Introduce yourself and your experience briefly.
or
Can you give a quick overview of your work journey?
or
Tell me a little about what you've been working on.
or
Share a bit about your role and what you've done so far.

ANSWER:

Tell me about yourself – **Max 2-minute simple answer** - Use this as a base. Fill in your details. Practice 5 times with a timer. No need to memorize – just make it your story

Small Intro

"My name is [Name], I'm from Mumbai. I have around 7 years of experience in data analytics, big data, and cloud. Over the years, I've enjoyed working with data and building systems that actually make life easier for teams."

Current Role

"Right now, I'm with Cisco, where I build data pipelines using Python, PySpark, Airflow, and SQL. I also work on ETL workflows and use AWS a lot. In one project, I helped cut processing time by about 40%, which meant business teams got their data much faster."

Previous Experience

"Before Cisco, I worked with Air Products, Accenture, and Amazon — mostly on cloud-based data solutions, improving reporting, and collaborating with different teams. A lot of my focus has been on making systems more scalable and improving data quality."

Certifications & Learning

“I’m certified in SQL and currently learning Google Cloud and Generative AI. I like to keep myself updated so I can add more value.”

Why this Country / Role

“What excites me about this role is that it matches my skills really well and gives me a chance to contribute while also learning and growing in [Country].”

Closing

“Overall, I’d describe myself as someone who likes solving problems, working with diverse teams, and keeping communication open and respectful. I’m really looking forward to contributing from day one.”

_____

Example Template:

_____

Small Intro

“My name is [Your Name]. I have around [X years] of experience in [main domain, e.g., network engineering, cloud infrastructure, software development]. Over the years, I’ve worked on [1–2 focus areas, e.g., network security, automation, cloud migrations], and I enjoy building systems that are reliable and scalable.”

Current Role

“Right now, I work at [Current Company], where I handle [main responsibilities, e.g., designing and managing enterprise networks, automating deployments, or building cloud-native solutions]. Recently, I [1 concrete achievement, e.g., improved network uptime by 25%, reduced deployment time by 40%, or saved costs through AWS optimization].”

Previous Experience

“Before this, I worked at [Previous Company/Companies], where I focused on [specific work, e.g., routing and switching, SD-WAN rollouts, migration to Azure, or developing backend APIs]. These roles gave me strong experience in [highlight key skills, e.g., large-scale troubleshooting, security compliance, cross-team collaboration].”

Certifications & Learning

“I hold [list certifications, e.g., Cisco CCIE, AWS Solutions Architect, ISTQB], and I’m currently learning [new skill or technology, e.g., Kubernetes, AI in networking, Google Cloud]. I like to stay updated so I can add value to every project.”

Why EU and This Role

“I’m particularly excited about this opportunity because it matches my skills in [skill] and [skill], and it gives me a chance to contribute to [company’s focus area, e.g., global network projects, cloud innovation, secure digital platforms]. I’m also looking forward to working in an international environment in [Country], which will help me grow both professionally and personally.”

Closing

“Overall, I’d describe myself as someone who likes solving problems, working closely with diverse teams, and keeping communication open. I’m confident I can contribute from day one and keep building value as I grow with your team.”

Questions: 2 Why do you want to work with us?

- They're trying to see if you're genuinely interested in the company and if you've done research about them.

  OR

Can you describe your current role and how it relates to the position you're applying for?

- This helps them understand if your experience aligns with the job requirements.

  OR

What skills do you bring to this role that will help us achieve our goals?

- This assesses whether your technical and soft skills align with their expectations.

Answer:

I’m really excited about the chance to join [Company Name] because I’ve been following your work in [mention specific area, e.g., cloud technologies, data analytics, etc.], and I’m impressed with what you’re doing, especially [mention a key project or value, e.g., helping businesses go digital or driving sustainability]. Your goals match mine, and I’d love to be part of your team.

Right now, at [Current Company], I work on [briefly describe your role, e.g., managing cloud infrastructure, improving network systems, developing software]. I've worked on projects like [mention a relevant project], which are very similar to what you need in this role. I have hands-on experience with [mention relevant skills/tools, e.g., AWS, Python, Cisco], which I think would be really valuable here.

Along with my technical skills, I'm also good at working with others, solving problems, and explaining things clearly. These skills have helped me collaborate across teams and make projects successful. I'm confident I can bring this same approach to your team and contribute to your goals from the start. I'm really looking forward to the opportunity to work with you.

Question 3: Notice Period:

- **What is your current notice period, and when can you join us?**
    - Be clear about your current notice period with your current employer and when you can start, keeping in mind any visa processing or relocation time.
- **Would you be able to join immediately, or is there any flexibility in your notice period?**
    - Some companies may need you sooner than expected, so they want to check if there's any flexibility.

Answer:

My current notice period is [X, 2/3 months]. However, there is a possibility to discuss it with my manager and shorten it to match your hiring needs. I'm committed to ensuring a smooth transition and can make myself available as soon as my notice period ends. I am also prepared to join within 1-2 days after my notice period ends and travel immediately if required.

Question 4. Salary Expectation:

- **What are your salary expectations for this role?**

I haven't had the chance to focus much on salary expectations yet, as I'm really focused on ensuring this role is a good fit for both of us. That being said, **I'm confident that I can work within the approved budget for this position.** Once we reach the later stages of the interview process and I have a better understanding of the role's full responsibilities, I'd be

happy to discuss a salary range that reflects my experience and the value I can bring to your team.

Important !!

Do you have any questions for me (When a recruiter asks you this Ques)?

That last moment — “Do you have any questions for me?” is actually your **chance to leave a strong impression. Instead of asking basic things** (like salary, working hours, etc.), you should ask thoughtful questions that show:

- You care about the role
- You want to grow with the company
- You’ve done your homework

Here are some **powerful impression-making questions** you can ask:

<Choose max 1-3 questions not more than that>

Role & Expectations

1. *“What does success look like in this role during the first 6 months?”*
2. *“If I were to join, what would be the first priority project you’d like me to focus on?”*

Growth & Learning

3. *“What learning opportunities or career growth paths do people in this role usually have?”*
4. *“Can you share an example of how someone in this team has grown into bigger responsibilities?”*

Team & Culture

5. *“How would you describe the team culture here?”*
6. *“What do you personally enjoy the most about working in this company?”*

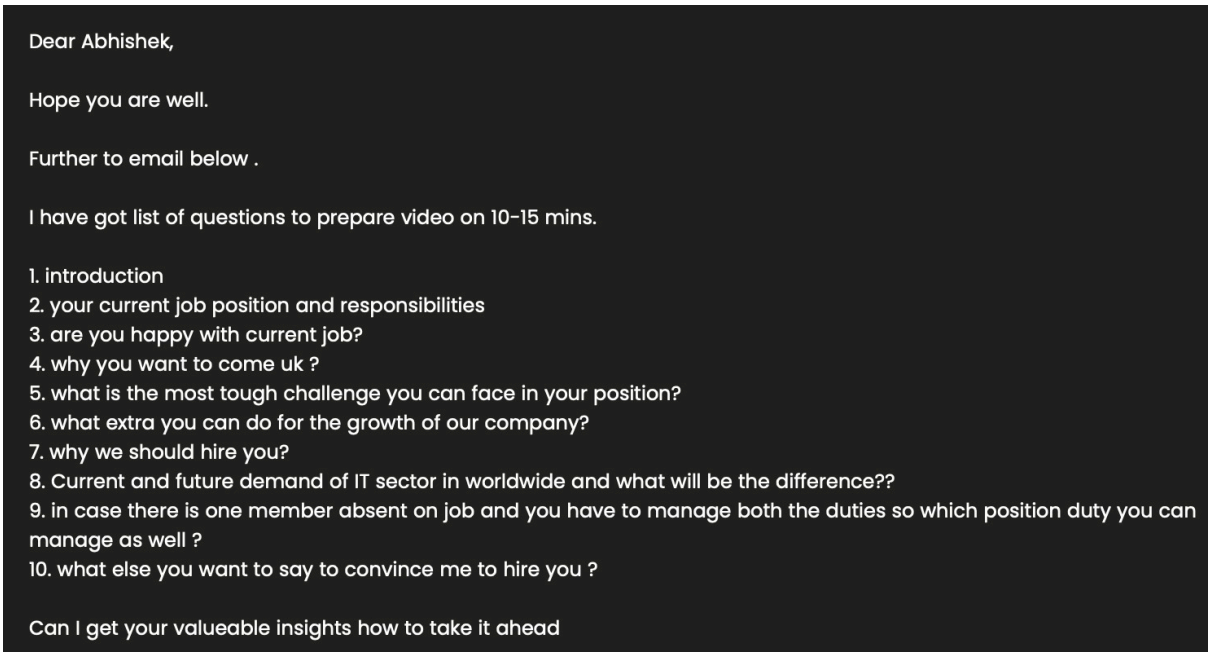
Impact & Future

7. *“What are the top challenges the team is currently facing that this role will help solve?”*
8. *“Where do you see the company heading in the next 2–3 years, and how does this role contribute to that vision?”*

Closing with Strength

9. *“Is there anything about my profile or answers today that you’d like me to clarify further before we close?”*
10. *“What would be the next step in the hiring process?”*

10-Minute Recording Questionnaire/Presentation:


Dear Abhishek,

Hope you are well.

Further to email below .

I have got list of questions to prepare video on 10-15 mins.

1. introduction
2. your current job position and responsibilities
3. are you happy with current job?
4. why you want to come uk ?
5. what is the most tough challenge you can face in your position?
6. what extra you can do for the growth of our company?
7. why we should hire you?
8. Current and future demand of IT sector in worldwide and what will be the difference??
9. in case there is one member absent on job and you have to manage both the duties so which position duty you can manage as well ?
10. what else you want to say to convince me to hire you ?

Can I get your valueable insights how to take it ahead

. Introduction (Max 2 Mins)

1. Tell me about yourself.
2. Why are you interested in working in Sweden?
3. What are your key strengths that make you a good fit for this role?
4. Are you comfortable working in -10°C temperature? How would you handle extreme cold?

2. Scenario-Based Technical Questions (Max 3-5 Mins)

5. In a team where there’s no boss, how would you make decisions and handle conflicts to keep things running smoothly?
6. Describe a challenging technical problem you faced in your domain and how you solved it.

7. Explain a time when you had to troubleshoot a major issue under pressure. What steps did you take?
8. You are working on a critical project, and a key component fails. How would you handle the situation?

3. Behavioral Questions (2-3 mins)

8. How do you adapt to working in a new country with a different culture?
9. Have you ever faced a language barrier at work? How did you overcome it?
10. Are you more comfortable working independently or in a team? Can you give an example?
11. Tell me about a time you had a conflict with a colleague. How did you resolve it?
12. Why should a company hire you over other candidates?

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